

Free MS Office

The Office 2010 Beta Build now available for download will be fully functional till October 2010

Dell eyes Indian SMBs

Dell is gearing to release solutions for the lucrative small and medium sized businesses in India

Feature

Enterprising ideas

Many people are increasingly looking at running their own businesses. We look at three such businesses that are run out of small offices...

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Pixeltek

Vitek Goyel is the 26-year old founder of this game studio. They do outsourced work for international gaming companies.

What's this SoHo about?

Animation studios are a plenty in India. Most of these studios have scores, if not hundreds, of artists working in plush offices, building 3D graphics for international gaming studios. Pixeltek is a lot like these studios that outsource game assets, except that it takes on the SoHo model. This studio has 12 people, that work out of a South Mumbai office. You would have seen their work in games like *TimeShift*, where they built the characters, or in *Ghostbusters* where they built some of the buildings or in the game *iRacing* where they built the cars and the race tracks.

How does this SoHo run?

Pixeltek turns five years old in February 2010. The team of graphic artists

has always hovered between nine and ten. They started out in a basement in Mumbai and then shifted to Bengaluru in their third year in an effort to cut costs. Eventually, for a range of issues they shifted back to Mumbai. They now operate from a 1500 square foot ground-floor office by the sea.

How does technology help further their business?

This studio has 12 high-end desktops to churn out those 3D graphics. In order to save on investing in rigs that will eventually require an upgrade, Pixeltek rents some of their machines. When an upgrade is required, they just send the machines back in and



Pixeltek started off as a small studio, but today works with the likes of Vivendi

ask for an upgrade. This ensures that they always have the latest hardware and are not burdened with enormous investments. Some of the older machines were bought on an installment program.

However one of the biggest expenses for an operation like this is the licensing for the high-end proprietary software.

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